SAESHA RUTLEDGE

PRODUCT MANAGER • PRODUCT STRATEGY & VISION • ENGINEERING BACKGROUND
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SUMMARY

Product leader with 3+ years owning product direction for a Washington State Department of Health registry, backed by 6+ years of hands-on software engineering. Shaped a product whose business rules differed sharply from other registries: filled gaps in the requirements with the agency, balanced user value, compliance impact, and technical feasibility, and delivered an on-schedule statewide launch now serving nearly 30,000 patients and providers. Makes decisions with incomplete information, translates technical tradeoffs for senior leaders, and coaches teams on the why behind the product.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Strategy Product vision & phased roadmaps • Prioritization by user value, business impact & feasibility • Success metrics & dashboards • Problem discovery • Requirements gap analysis

Leadership Senior stakeholder alignment • Influence without authority • Coaching teams on product context • Executive communication

Methods & Technical Agile/Scrum (CSPO, CSM) • UAT partnership • Jira • Node.js • TypeScript • React • SQL • REST APIs • AWS • Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

Solutions Architect · VisualVault — May 2023 – Present

- **Product Vision –** Own product direction for the Washington State Department of Health's medical cannabis registry, setting a phased roadmap across five three-month releases from discovery through an on-schedule statewide launch and ongoing improvements.
- **Complex Problem Solving –** The registry required business rules unlike other registries; reconciled the given requirements with the agency's undocumented process and drew out the missing rules through twice-weekly stakeholder sessions before build.
- **Business Impact –** Shaped the Fiserv payments solution that replaced manual fee collection and mailed notices with electronic payment; retailers that don't pay can no longer participate in the registry, a compliance lever the agency previously lacked.
- **Success Metrics –** Designed the data model behind the agency's first owned view of its registry, now the source of its published statistics: nearly 30,000 patients and providers, 300+ retailers, and 14,000+ card transactions in the first half of 2026.
- **Stakeholder Alignment –** Made sure agency stakeholders understood what was being built so they could write accurate UAT test cases; explain tradeoffs to agency leaders and report delivery metrics to executives through Jira dashboards.
- **Coaching & Product Mindset –** Mentor 8 developers and 5 QA engineers beyond the technical, teaching the business rules and the why behind them so they make sound decisions independently; introduced QA review of stories before refinement.
- **Technical Fluency –** Serve as lead architect and hands-on developer, so priorities reflect what is technically feasible; build daily with Claude Code and GitHub Copilot.

Software Engineer, Browse & Search · Macy's Technology — Mar 2022 – May 2023

- **Customer Impact at Scale –** Shipped browse and search features on macys.com and bloomingdales.com (~70 million combined monthly visits), using feature flags to de-risk releases.
- **Product Partnership –** Partnered with product managers, QA, and business stakeholders to define acceptance criteria before implementation.

Software Engineer · ProCom Consulting — Mar 2021 – Mar 2022

- **Decisions Under Ambiguity –** Lead developer for payments and refunds on the State of Nebraska licensure system; turned vague, undocumented requirements into working behavior and mapped downstream impacts.
- **Documentation –** Designed the PayPal Payflow integration and authored the payments architecture and business-rule documentation the team used after handoff.

Software Engineer · Salepoint LLC — Apr 2020 – Mar 2021

- **Legacy Modernization –** Reverse-engineered legacy Oracle Forms logic driving supply chain and merchandising for Department of Defense AAFES stores and migrated it to Oracle APEX; held Public Trust clearance.

EDUCATION

Certificate, Full Stack Software Engineering · DigitalCrafts | **CSPO & CSM** · Scrum Alliance (expired)

Ph.D., Musicology and Ethnomusicology · University of Kentucky
GPA 4.0. Published peer-reviewed research and presented internationally; taught university-level courses.

B.M., Music Performance, magna cum laude · Boise State University